

The Holy Spirit's Intercession for Us

Tongues for Edification and Tongues for Travail Are Different Operations

We are studying the difference between tongues for personal edification and tongues that empower the believer to stand in the gap: the deep intercessional groanings of the Spirit that empower the believer to stand between hell and people trying to get there. Amen.

We began in First Corinthians 12 and studied diversities of tongues, one of the nine gifts. We found out that he called it diversities of tongues because there are four basic variations, four basic operations of tongues that the Spirit operates.

Where we have gotten into trouble is that we have clumped the same set of rules onto all the diversities, all the basic operations of the empowerment of tongues.

Again, diversities of tongues has four basic empowerments.

Number one is tongues for personal edification. That is the one you and I received when we were filled with the Holy Ghost.

Number two is tongues for the sole purpose of interpretation. That is when God uses tongues to open the channel to the Spirit world so He can bring a message of exhortation or comfort to the believers. Tongues for interpretation is different from tongues for edification, and it is different from tongues for intercession.

Number three is tongues that extends itself into the deep intercession or groanings of the Spirit, groanings that literally empower a man to stand in the gap between hell and people trying to get there, between dope and your children, between sin and your children. Intercession is the third basic diversity of tongues.

Number four is tongues that presents itself in a public assembly as a sign to the unbeliever. This tongue operates through a believer and empowers that believer to speak any language on the face of this earth or in heaven that he had no previous knowledge of. He never spoke a word of German or French, yet he will stand up with sinners present and begin to preach in their own native tongue.

Brother, you can cut that any way you want. That is a sign to the unbeliever.

We do not want to put the same set of rules on all the diversities of tongues. If we do, we will confuse ourselves, and even more than that, we will confuse the world. There is one set of rules for tongues for personal edification and another set for tongues for deep intercessional groanings.

The Devil Knows Travail Means Birth but Not What Is Being Birthed

One question people always ask me is, "Brother Roberson, can the devil understand me when I am praying in tongues?"

Let me tell you what the devil understands about deep intercessional groanings. He understands that you are fixing to give birth, and he does not like it. What he does not know is what you are about to birth.

The reason he does not know what you are about to birth is because it began months earlier in the form of a seed when you were praying in tongues and activating the plan of God in your spirit.

That is just a little hint of what is to come. He does not like it when you are groaning. He says, "They are going to give birth. What are they going to give birth to?"

He trembles until the child is born, because then he is forced to take his hands off one of his children, whether he likes it or not.

Have you ever had the Holy Ghost visit you and say, "Get out"? You get out.

When they ask me if the devil understands what is going on when you are making intercession and groaning, yes, he understands you are about to give birth.

"How about when I am praying in tongues for my own personal edification?"

Once again, all the other eight gifts, and the three other diversities of tongues, are operated by the Spirit severally as He wills. The only gift operated at my will is that one-fourth, that diversity of tongues that is for my personal edification.

That is the only gift, the only diversity of all nine, that operates by my own will, because God has made me the steward of it. All the other eight and three-quarter gifts flow outward for your edification, but that one flows inward for mine. Therefore, I am the steward of my own edification.

I am the steward of my own edification because all the other gifts are designed for your edification as they flow through me. But that one flows inward in me, to me, for my own edification. Therefore, by my own will, I am the steward of it.

"Do you control God?"

No.

"Do you turn God on and off?"

No.

"Then how come you can pray in tongues anytime you want?"

Because He made me the steward of its operation. I do not control it. I do not own it. I am the steward of it. Anytime my faith says, "I want to pray," then as steward of it, the Holy Spirit automatically activates that language for my own edification.

But it is different from the deep intercessional groanings. Those are activated severally as God wills. A woman can get pregnant about anytime she wants, but she cannot have the baby anytime she wants. That comes when it comes.

How many of you are having a good time already?

Tongues for Edification Is a Closed Channel Between the Believer and God

Does the devil know what I am doing when I am making deep intercessional groanings? Yes, he knows you are about to birth something. He does not know quite what, but he knows you are about to give birth.

Does he know what I am doing when I am praying in tongues? Yes, he knows what you are doing. He knows you have reverted to the inside of your spirit and locked in with God in a divine flow of communication.

"Does he know what I am saying?"

No. When you are speaking in tongues for personal edification, he does not know what you are saying.

"I know people who say he does."

Well, he does not.

Let me give you some deductive reasoning. Do you know what you are praying when you are praying in tongues? No. Would you think this was fair: you do not know, but the devil knows? That is not fair.

Does the devil know any tongues I speak? Yes. There are certain diversities of tongues you will speak that are the language of angels. When that diversity comes on you, yes, the spirit world, angels, and sometimes devils and demons will hear a language they are familiar with.

But not the diversity that operates for your own edification, because that is a holy place you have entered into, locked in with God, your spirit with His. It is a closed channel. The communication is between you and God, for that man speaks unto God, and he is edified.

Hallelujah. Glory to God.

It is none of the devil's business when my Father and I are in holy communication.

God Loaned a Heavenly Vocabulary to Express Redemption in Us

Let me tell you something about tongues. It is such a peculiar language, and it is. The world looks at us as peculiar, and they do.

"Are you those people who speak in tongues? Yes, I heard about you. Psychiatrists say you are a little off, but harmless. Good folk, good folk, but just a little psychologically off balance. You have to have some phenomenon in your life to believe God is with you, so you jabber in this strange language. My minister warned me about you all. That stuff has all passed away."

No. Their life has passed away. We have been warned about this stuff.

Maybe you think we are peculiar. I said, "Lord, they think we are peculiar."

Yes, well, we are. We definitely are.

You know as well as I do that peculiar does not mean weird. Peculiar means when there is famine, you eat. Peculiar means when there is plague, it does not come near your dwelling.

That is peculiar.

They say, "How come you are not getting it?"

You called us peculiar. We are peculiar. Die, or become peculiar.

Hallelujah.

Will the devil understand it? No.

I said, "Lord, why such a peculiar language?"

He finally said to me, "Among men there has never been a language that has come into existence that carries the vocabulary to express everything I am in you through Christ Jesus. Since there was no language with such a vocabulary, I had to create My own and loan it to you while you are down there. I just loaned it to you until you come up here, and then it will cease."

Meanwhile, because you know in part, He knows everything. He knows the whole redemption plan. He knows it all.

Whenever the devil comes against you, God says, "Do not worry about it. I will activate." Because of your infirmities, He will make intercession. He who searches the heart knows the entire plan of God, so He will begin making intercession for you according to that plan.

All eternity, the entire redemption, is involved. He says, "I prayed the will of that into existence in your life. Even though you only know in part, I prayed the part that you need, and the devil has no idea what is going on."

It makes a man want to go pray in tongues, does it not?

The Righteous Human Spirit Groans for Redemption's Completion

We are defining the difference between tongues for my edification and the deep intercessional groanings of the Spirit, which are only activated severally as He wills. Tongues for edification is activated as I will because I am the steward of its operation.

The devil knows that when you are groaning and travailing, you are about to birth something. He does not like it.

Look at Galatians 4:19 for a moment:

My little children,
of whom I travail in birth again
until Christ be formed in you.

If we are really going to understand this, we should go back to our old friend, Romans 8.

Let us begin with verse 23:

And not only they,
but ourselves also,
which have the firstfruits of the Spirit,
even we ourselves groan within ourselves,
waiting for the adoption,
to wit,
the redemption of our body.

The adoption will be culminated, completed, at the redemption of our bodies. What this is actually saying is that the redemption of our body will be secondfruits. That is why he says we have the firstfruits.

What in the world are the firstfruits of the Spirit?

Jesus rose from the dead. He resurrected. Those of us who are born again have become the firstfruits of His resurrection. We are the first harvest of His resurrection.

When I bowed my knee to the Lord Jesus Christ, when I was born again, adoption papers were served on me. I became His firstfruits.

When I was born again, something happened to me. My spirit man was instantly seated in a heavenly place with Christ Jesus. It entered into zoe, God-kind of life, the I Am, eternally seated in that heavenly place with Christ Jesus.

When my spirit took on the expressed image of Jesus Christ, it was born of Him, born of Jesus. Consequently, because it has been born of Jesus, it has become the righteousness of God in Christ.

On the inside of me I have these righteous feelings. In fact, there is something in me so holy that it wars continually with my flesh. You know exactly what I am talking about.

Those of us who have the firstfruits of the Spirit groan. We groan within our righteous spirits, waiting for the entire adoption process to be completed at the redemption of our bodies.

"Then are you telling me, Brother Roberson, that our bodies are not redeemed yet?"

You know as well as I do that this is speaking in a corporeal sense. This flesh is dying. It has the death working in it that you and I inherited from the first Adam. It is dying. In fact, it is capable of sin. It will sin if you let it.

That is why he says:

Walk in the Spirit,
and ye shall not fulfil the lust of the flesh.

You have the firstfruits. You have been born again and filled with the Holy Ghost. But the reason you are groaning on the inside of your righteous spirit is that you are imprisoned in this body.

I live in here. This thing not only will sin, it is capable of sin. It is capable of walking in the flesh. Even more than that, my body is imprisoned in this world, with wars, strife, children starving to death, men killing each other, and sin rampant.

My righteous spirit groans within my body. I am groaning because I am in this world with all this damnable sin. In fact, all creation is travailing like a pregnant woman to be delivered out of it. I am in the middle of it, and the righteousness implanted in me makes me groan. I want to be delivered out of it.

He Learned That His Hunger and Hurt Were Already Groaning

I had this happen before I had spent enough time in prayer to know what deep intercessional groanings were. I had begun to spend time praying in tongues. I knew people who prayed and interceded and groaned a lot, but the only thing that ever came on me was praying in tongues. Anytime I wanted to pray in tongues, I could pray in tongues.

But I saw those people step in and start groaning for the lost:

"Oh God, save the lost!"

The problem was they would have to jump up and check their watch.

"I have five minutes to go."

I thought, "How do they get in and out of it like that?"

"Oh wait, I have five more minutes. The lost!"

Two minutes.

I could pray in tongues anytime I wanted, but in deep meditations, when I crossed over this verse about those who have the firstfruits groaning within their righteous spirits, I did not know what it meant.

I told God I had never been so happy in my whole life. I had just gone full-time. You would have to be as hungry as I was at that time to understand where I am coming from. I was so hungry to pray, so hungry to fast, yet I was imprisoned to a job by my unbelief. I was thirty years old, and I hurt.

Then God visited me supernaturally. That gave me the faith and inspired me to go full-time. I went full-time, and for the first time in my life I had the freedom to pray and fast as much as I wanted to, as long as I wanted to.

For a man who had been bound by unbelief to a job while a call was eating a hole in the inside of his spirit, I was elated. I was in spiritual hog heaven.

Do you know what hog heaven is? Hog heaven is a hog with a bunch of farmers lined up with buckets of slop and no end to it. That is hog heaven.

I was elated. I said, "Oh, glory to God."

When I came across the place that says we are groaning to be delivered out of all this, waiting for the redemption, I said, "Not me. I like it here. Glory to God. I just got turned loose on the devil. Do not come for at least one hundred years."

The Holy Spirit said, "You are groaning."

I said, "No, I am not. I ought to know if I am groaning."

He said, "Yes, you are groaning."

I said, "No, I am not."

Especially at the time I was believing God for five hundred dollars to catch up the bills in the first three months I went full-time. I was praying in tongues and fasting. Glory to God.

Then a man walked up to me in a service where all I was doing was catching. Nobody let me preach yet. I was pretty good at catching for a friend of mine. The man walked up to me after the service. It was not my meeting at all. God knows, Earl Hitchens and I agreed.

This man handed me a check for seven hundred thirty-six dollars. I stuck that check in my pocket, and it was one hundred miles home. Every couple miles I would reach out and pat it. It was still there.

After three months of standing in faith every way I knew how, just ignoring my cupboards:

"Get away from me, cupboards."

Every time the grocery man asked when I was going to pay the bill, I would say, "I have a new job. I expect to be paid any time." Then I would walk away and say, "Get behind me."

So I patted that check.

When I got home, my wife and I went down to the bank. We did not have gas money, so we had to walk to the bank. I forgot how to sign my name.

I said, "I want to put this into our account. Now when I put this into the account, can I honestly write checks off this?"

He said, "Yes. What is the matter with you?"

I said, "I just wanted to be sure."

I want you to know my wife and I walked hand in hand. A new day had dawned. I was in fourth hog heaven. Every time I crossed a little raindrop hanging off the bottom of a leaf, I could see God in it.

A new day had dawned. We walked to every bill and paid them. Then I turned around and gave another old preacher one hundred dollars, and that cleaned me out.

But at that point it did not matter whatsoever. I had something much more valuable: an unshakable faith in the grace of my God.

I was elated.

I said, "I am not groaning."

He said, "Yes, you are. Do you like the plan the devil has for the world?"

I said, "No, I hurt inside."

He said, "Yes, you are groaning out of your righteous spirit. If you are groaning for the culmination of all things, you are groaning for the redemption of the body. You are groaning to see this whole horrible future mess come to an end."

I said, "Yes, sir. You are right."

That groaning, that hurting, was coming out of my righteous human spirit. It was coming out of the nature He made me when He made me a new creation in Christ Jesus. That nature hurt inside. I had grown to hurt.

Compassion Feels the Limits of Flesh and Longs for Redemption's Power

This was after approximately two years of praying intermittently, hour upon hour. I started experiencing that hurt time after time. It is not a bad kind.

Every time I had to walk away from a wheelchair and had prayed, knowing that I knew He had borne our sicknesses and carried our pains, and that He finished in redemption everything that woman or man needed, I had to walk away in dumb days when very few people were getting

healed. I would hurt on the inside because I could feel my limitations.

I wanted to do something about it so badly, but I could not. If I could have, I would have. I felt the limitations imposed on me by the flesh. I hurt just like I hurt when I saw whole civilizations starving to death in plain view of the whole world.

Tongues for deep intercessional groaning is activated severally as He wills. But even if I have that cold, indifferent, stony heart, the fact that I know it is wrong and the fact that I can pray in tongues by my own will as much as I want to are the two ingredients I need to bring me to that other place.

If your five-year-old child was run over in a crosswalk right in front of you, what would you do? Check your watch?

"Oh well, he got run over at 8:30. That is too bad."

No. Your travail would reach the throne room of God.

The Spirit Also Helps the Infirmities Our Righteous Spirit Already Groans Over

Look again at Romans 8:23:

And not only they,
but ourselves also,
which have the firstfruits of the Spirit,
even we ourselves groan within ourselves,
waiting for the adoption,
to wit,
the redemption of our body.

Those of us who have been born again and filled with the Holy Ghost groan within ourselves, waiting for the adoption process to be completed, the redemption of our body.

Then he says:

For we are saved by hope:
but hope that is seen is not hope:
for what a man seeth,
why doth he yet hope for?
But if we hope for that we see not,
then do we with patience wait for it.

What are we hoping for? The redemption of the body. Do we see it yet? No. So with patience we wait for it.

Buddy, you do not have any choice. You can believe God until you turn blue and seven shades of white and green, and Jesus is still going to come back when He is going to come back. We are going to be changed in the twinkling of an eye, from corruptible to incorruptible. We are going to receive a resurrected body spawned from the loins of the last Adam, Jesus Christ, that life-giving Spirit.

Until that time, while we are waiting, in the earnest of our inheritance, we are born again. But he said we are saved by hope. We patiently wait while we are stuck in this body.

That is why He gives you the Holy Spirit. The Holy Spirit empowers you and me during this waiting time.

This is what I like about Romans 8:26:

Likewise the Spirit also helpeth our infirmities:
for we know not what we should pray for as we ought:
but the Spirit itself maketh intercession for us
with groanings which cannot be uttered.

"Likewise" means in like manner. The Spirit also helps our infirmities. We know from times past that "infirmities" breaks down to mean our inability to produce results because of the limitations imposed on us by this flesh.

I have limitations absolutely imposed on me by this flesh. That is why he says those of us who have the firstfruits are groaning out of a righteous spirit to see the whole imposition removed.

Meanwhile, while we are patiently waiting, he says in this same manner the Spirit helps our infirmities, our inability imposed on us by this flesh.

Notice the wording closely: "Likewise the Spirit also helpeth our infirmities." If He is also helping, what else is helping?

This gets interesting. I cannot leave words out. Knowing eternity is weighing on the Word of God, I cannot pass one word up.

He said the Spirit also helps Dave Roberson's infirmities. I appreciate that help, because I found out I am not too smart when it comes to inability to produce results, especially in spiritual things.

Whenever I am facing a wheelchair and the inability through unbelief to produce the result is imposed on me to where it hurts, He says, "This is likewise the Spirit helping your infirmity, Roberson, because you do not know how to pray as you ought."

If I knew how to pray as I ought, I could have gotten him out. So He is helping my inability to produce that result.

Brother, that is in a realm very few of us have any understanding in at all. "I am going to pray and just believe God." Why did it not happen? Nobody knows, not even the person in the wheelchair. But I will tell you about Someone who does.

He says the Spirit will help your inability to produce these results. But He says He also helps. If He is also helping, I need all the help I can get. I also wonder what else is helping, because He would not say He also helps unless it was in conjunction with something already helping.

That means there are two of them doing something.

That throws us back to verse 23. Those of us who have the firstfruits of the Spirit are groaning out of our righteous human spirit. That one is out of my human spirit. But then in verse 26, he says, "Likewise the Spirit also." The "likewise" means that in the same manner you are groaning out of your human spirit, He will also help you.

This is the difference. When I pray in tongues until it edifies me and charges me like a battery into the love of God, until compassion grabs hold of me and at times I feel like I cannot live unless I see results, I hurt inside because I had to walk away from another wheelchair.

It is that kind of groaning the Holy Spirit picks up on. He says, "Look, he has edified himself to a place where he is groaning out of his spirit because of all the damnable limitations on him."

Then the Holy Spirit picks up on your righteous groaning and adds His anointing of power, His intercession, His groanings. In unison they blend together as one, and the Spirit empowers you to rise above the problem and gives you the power from God to do something about it.

My little children,
of whom I travail in birth again
until Christ be formed in you.

The Spirit Searches the Heart With God's Whole Plan in View

Now this next part you will have to hang on to closely. We are going to outline the distinct difference between tongues for personal edification and the deep intercessional groanings of the Spirit, that gift operated by God at the time of birth.

How many of you women picked a day to have your child and had it on that day, not accidentally? How many of you stopped it and said, "I will wait two days"? It was not as severally as you willed, was it?

But like I said, you can pretty well know when you want to start the walk that will lead toward the intercession and travail.

Here comes the difference. Look at verse 27:

And he that searcheth the hearts
knoweth what is the mind of the Spirit,
because he maketh intercession for the saints
according to the will of God.

He searches the hearts, plural. That is your heart and my heart, the hearts of the entire body of Christ at once. It is the Holy Spirit who does that searching. He is our Champion. He is our Representative.

He who searches your heart and mine knows what is the mind of the Spirit. "Mind of the Spirit" is present tense. It means He searches your heart knowing the entire redemption plan of God, from where it began to where it will end.

To bring it into present tense, He not only knows the redemption plan of God from beginning to end, but He knows the mind of God for you in that plan right now. What is for this moment? That becomes God's mind for you in the redemption plan for that moment.

That is why He becomes your individual Representative. He searches your heart as an individual, knows the entire plan of God, and knows what God called you to do and where you fit in it.

Before the foundation of the world, before anything was, around the conference table of God, your name came up. When it did, God laid His entire plan for your life on the table. Jesus redeemed you, and the Holy Spirit came forth armed with the knowledge of everything He heard about you around that conference table.

He goes into your heart to search it for the sole purpose of making intercession for you according to the plan He heard for your specific life.

God planned this for you from the beginning, knowing the time would come when Adam might fall and you would be born of that dead seed. God mapped out a plan for your life from birth. Whether you find that plan or not, every child born in India had a specific plan in redemption from God. If he lives, dies, and goes to hell, it does not exclude the fact that God had a whole plan for him that he never found.

Some of you will never finish the end of what He called you to do. Some of you will. One thing is for sure: that plan is in the Spirit, and He is in you. He knows the entire redemption plan of God. Every time He searches your heart, He does it with the intention to pray that plan, that mind of God, into existence in your life.

Praying in Tongues Lets Heart-Desires Direct the Spirit's Prayer

Does God have a plan for your husband? Does God have a plan for your wife? Does God have a plan for your brother-in-law, your sister, your children's children, your relatives, and your family trees? Does God have a specific plan for all of them?

Let me tell you what begins to happen. When you start praying in tongues as an act of your own will, the Holy Spirit continually creates the language and prays according to the plan God has for you in this life.

When He starts praying for you and building you up into a place of sensitivity, pretty soon you start looking at your husband or wife and thinking, "Oh God, above everything, I want them to be saved."

At that point, the desires of your heart begin to change because of edification and love. You are taking the first steps toward intercession.

You are not directing the Holy Spirit's prayer. You may think you are.

"We are going to have a list here. Joe needs a car. Susie needs this. Jan needs this."

All that stuff to God is almost irrelevant. If they find the Spirit, they will find all that. You are sitting there with your big list, and you say, "Okay, we claim this stuff."

The actual part that had to do with it was when you said, "We claim it." God heard it. But when you say, "We are going to pray in the Spirit about it," the desires of your heart begin to direct your prayer, not your mentality.

It is the desires of your heart that start empowering your prayer. What did God say? He would grant you the desires of your heart if you delighted yourself in Him. That means the desires of your heart would come from Him. If I delight myself in the Lord by praying, then the desires I have will come from Him, and they are the kind He can produce.

No, you are not directing your prayer language anymore. You may think you are. He would not have given you a supernatural language He created if you could have gotten the job done. Since you messed it up so badly, He gave you an insurance policy.

There is the petition of faith, and thank God He hears that. Then there is the one that concerns His will.

When you start praying in tongues, that prayer is directed by your heart.

You pray yourself into a place of sensitivity. Pretty soon you turn around and look at your husband, your wife, the man you hate, your boss, the fellow you used to fight and talk bad about to everybody. You could have cared less. In fact, you kind of hoped he would make it to hell.

"He treated me like that. Brother, do not push me around."

You can change things, all right. You can sue his socks off and get all his money, or you can get him born again and he will give it to you anyway. Which route do you want to take?

"I will take the arm of the flesh."

Pretty soon you will turn around and say, "Oh God, give me this soul, lest I die." Your heart will hurt for it.

At that time, the Holy Spirit begins to plant a little seed. Do you know what the seed is? It is conception. It is the birth plan for your husband. He plants a little seed for that son or daughter in doubt.

When He plants it, directed by the desires of your heart, it is the birth plan. As you pray in tongues, God, through the authority of your spirit, begins to form that little baby in Christ.

Pretty soon you are seven months along, and you keep praying that plan the Spirit knows for that man. He knows it, and you keep praying it. It is in you. You are carrying it.

Then eight months comes, and everybody notices. You are showing. You do not care if people play with you. You are up early. You are up at times in the night. You are walking around craving things you never used to want.

"Chocolate. Give me chocolate."

The birth is in there.

As God works this plan, He who searches the heart knows the plan of God and makes intercession according to the will of God. God has a plan for your husband, your wife, your children, and hope. That is the conception taking place and working in you now.

Eight months goes by. Nine months goes by. All of a sudden, not by an act of your own will, but because it is time for birth, you go, "Oh! Oh! Better get me to a hospital!"

The labor pains get closer and closer. In the Spirit, when the birth takes place, that is when Satan has to step back in your travail, in your wailings, in your groanings. He will step back. That child will be birthed in the spiritual realm, and it is only a matter of time until he makes his appearance in this world.

A Deaf Woman's Healing Was Birthed Before She Entered the Prayer Line

I entered into this not only in tongues for intercession, but also in the intermittent times of birth, the hard groanings, the hard intercession. Things began to happen. The limitations imposed on me in the realms of the Spirit began to be broken. I mean broken.

I will never forget the time I was interceding and went deaf. I went semi-deaf, not deaf in the sense that I could not hear anything, but in the Spirit something happened. I was placed over into another place. Everything became foreign, and although I could hear, I could not hear. It was

spiritual, so I knew it was deafness.

That night, I saw a woman step up in front of me in the prayer line, watching my lips.

She said, "I am deaf. I am reading your lips. I cannot hear a thing you are saying."

I said, "How long have you been deaf, ma'am?"

She said, "Since birth."

I said, "How old are you?"

She said, "I am thirty-three. I have a son and I have a husband, but I have never heard their voices."

Then it came back to me that in my motel room, evidently because of edification, God had privileged me to slide into her shoes for the purpose of giving birth to her healing.

I laid hands on her, and the power of God came to me like a rushing wind. It hit her, and she went backward under the power. Halfway to the floor, the noise of the room filled her head. She jerked straight out. It took her by such storm that she kicked, her eyes flew open, and she came straight back up as quickly as she had gone down.

She stood in front of me with her mouth as wide as any mouth I have ever seen. There was cold silence in the room.

I said, "Can you hear me?"

She said, "Oh my God. Brother Roberson, I can hear you."

She turned around and grabbed her husband, and for the first time in her existence, she heard the voice of her husband. Then her boy bolted from the crowd, and she heard his voice. The band began to play again, and she said, "My God, music. That is music, is it not?"

I said, "Yes."

We almost had to fight her to keep her from washing my feet with her tears and drying them with her hair. It was my privilege.

When I say, "I have stared at too many motel walls to lose this one," that is what I mean.

Endurance in Prayer Built Something That Converted to Power

In the early days of the ministry, I began to understand some of these principles inside, though I could not yet put them into words. I would get man after man turned on to faith.

In three years we launched forty ministries. Forty ministries. We started more than twenty churches in three years, put pastors in them, and I started them myself.

I was so hungry I would meet myself coming. I would have to get up to give myself the chair. I preached day and night, day and night. Anybody who would listen to me, I preached to them.

I endured every damnable thing the devil could throw at me, from sleeping in halls because I did not have enough money for a motel room, to wearing those putrid suits, to driving my car into the woods and lying in it and praying all day because I had nowhere to go, just so I could come out and say something to those people.

Let me tell you what that kind of endurance does. It builds something on the inside of a man that converts to power.

You say, "Lay hands on me. I want the power of God."

What do you want?

I begged my colleagues who got turned on to faith at the same time. I said, "Praying in tongues is doing something. If you want to succeed, pray in tongues. Pray in tongues. Pray in tongues. Please, pray in tongues."

Many of them would launch out, and I would go on crusades with them. We would walk the floor and match each other hour for hour.

Please do not get me wrong. I would not even say the sheep are called to do that all the time. If some crisis comes and it is weighing heavily on your heart, pray your way out of it, because your heart will direct your prayer. That is what I am saying.

I am not putting condemnation on you because you are not up two hours in the morning and two at night. Your righteousness is quite enough. Your rebirth will carry you all the way to heaven. The reality of that righteousness, a good working relationship with the church, and faithfulness are enough.

But to those colleagues I begged, "Please do it." One by one, they dropped out. A handful stayed, and they are making it today. My God, they have strong ministries. But the ones who dropped out, I begged them.

"Please."

Finally, it came to light. My meetings were getting bigger and bigger. Theirs were doing what most do: up, down, up, down, down, mostly down.

When the truth came out, they said, "I maintained that prayer like you said for a month or so, and I started getting depressed. At times I did not even feel saved. I labored under that and tried to preach, and I did not even do a good job. But when I quit praying, the anointing came and I got into a flow and did really well after that. So I think you can overdo tongues."

I did not want to tell them, but I went through the same thing. I felt like quitting. I did not feel saved. I felt depressed. I walked the four walls. It was not always really edifying. Sometimes I wanted to cry, and I would say, "God, I do not even feel saved. I feel creepy. I feel dirty. Why?"

But I would not quit praying, because the Word of God says you are building yourself up on your most holy faith, and I was too hungry to stop.

Do you know what would happen? I would pray my way, blunder my way, through that thing. All of a sudden the meetings would grow real big, and a whole bunch of people would run to the front to be saved.

I would say, "Would you look at this?"

Later, when He gave me understanding, I realized I had made it to a plane of intercession. He had actually privileged me to slip into the shoes and stand in the gap between those people who were trying to get to hell until they were born again in my services.

Hallelujah.

I like this.

A Paralyzed Arm in Intercession Preceded a Pastor's Wife Being Healed

After we began teaching this, one powerful ministry that launched out taught their church the principles of intercession. They taught their head intercessor, and brother, they knew how to pray. They would pray heaven and hell together.

One day the head intercessor was making intercession. The group was with her, and she went over into groaning. They were birthing something, a real one.

All of a sudden, when she was in the height of the Spirit, her left arm became paralyzed. She could not move it. The deadness crept up over her whole left side. They could not straighten it out. She lay there. She came out of the hard intercession, and that stayed on her arm for hours until the entire anointing lifted and her hand went free.

It kind of scared her.

Two weeks later, the pastor's wife had a tumor come to full size that pressed on the brain and paralyzed her whole left side. Immediately they ran and got that intercessor, who had already taken care of it two weeks before.

When she prayed, of course, the thing had already been delivered in the Spirit. It had already been birthed. Hell or high water, nobody could stop that healing. It took place. Everything went free. It was an instantaneous miracle.

True Intercession Comes and Lifts With the Anointing

Let me tell you something. There is a place in Him. There are people who do not know how to give up day and night. Some of them lose their husbands and say, "Nobody can fill the gap inside me. Nobody can fill the vacancy my husband left but God."

Like Anna the prophetess, who was told of Jesus and saw Him when He was a baby. She saw Him. All the religious men missed Him, but that intercessor got her eyes on Jesus.

There are people whose vacancy cannot be filled by anything natural. They are in a state of hunger.

People get confused over the gifts of the Spirit because they need a spiritual understanding of them. In other words, you almost have to possess them to understand them. You cannot carnally teach inner spiritual principles.

I know people who try to operate in the Spirit and are actually in the flesh. Things will come on a true intercessor during intercession. But when the intercession is over, whatever came on will lift with the anointing because it came with it.

God calls you to be normal, a housewife or a husband. When the intercession time and anointing are there, it will be there.

I have heard people say, "I carried the pain for somebody for three days."

"Were you under the anointing the whole time?"

"Well, no."

"When did it come on?"

"It just came on me."

If it was for somebody else, it would have come and left with the anointing. He did not call you to bear infirmities. It will come and it will leave with the anointing. After all, we have to live here.

"But I took the place of the lost for months and months."

You may feel the compassion of the Spirit, but you will not carry that lost feeling. It will go when the anointing lifts. He did not call you to labor under that. He will put it on you as much as you can take, and He will lift it off.

But I am talking about a realm some of you do not know much about.

"Yes, I was in intercession."

You probably are. Grow up.